STARTUP QC

STUDENT CATEGORY · SQUAD 3

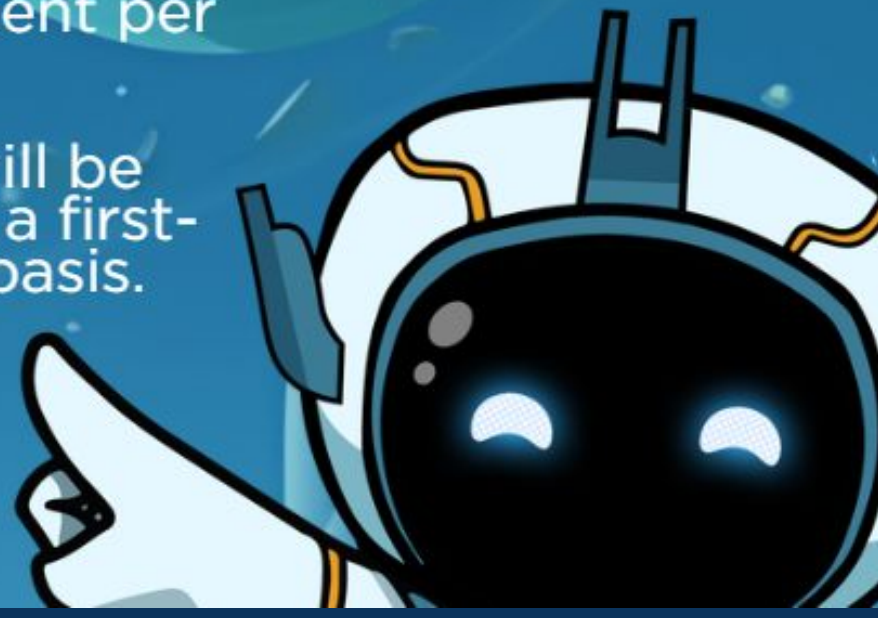
# Unlocking the Secrets to an Effective Pitch

The Anatomy of a Winning Pitch

Abe Lozada · LaunchGarage × Startup QC

# PITCH PRACTICE

- Each team will have a maximum of 5 minutes for pitching and 10 minutes for mentor feedback.
- Scan the QR code to schedule your practice session.
- Only one appointment per team is allowed.
- Practice sessions will be accommodated on a first-come, first-served basis.



WHAT WE'LL COVER TODAY

# Coverage

1. The Pitch
2. Presentation
3. Content — the major parts of a pitch
4. What Makes a Pitch Land
5. Q & A
6. Your Turn: pitch it

HELLO, I'M

# Abe Lozada

**General Manager, LaunchGarage**

Industry partner of Startup QC. I help founders sharpen how they pitch, tell their story, and win over clients and investors.



SECTION

# The Pitch

What is it, really?

# What is a Pitch?

**The go-to introduction and sales exercise of every founder.**

**ASK YOURSELF**

- *A typical founder pitches 2–5 times a day.*
- *It is the fastest way people decide if you're worth their time.*
- *Master it once — reuse it everywhere.*

ONE SKILL, THREE SETTINGS

# Different Kinds of Pitches

## Elevator Pitch

30–60 seconds to spark interest and earn the next conversation.

## Sales or Partnerships Pitch

Show a reliable solution, revenue, or cost savings to a client or partner.

## Competition / Investment Pitch

Prove the opportunity, traction, and impact to judges or investors.

SECTION

# Presentation

How it should go

02

BEFORE YOU DESIGN A SINGLE SLIDE

# Presentation Fundamentals

## Target Audience

Tailor every slide to who is in the room and what they care about.

## Scientific & Data-Driven

Back your claims with evidence, numbers, and validated proof.

## Flow

Sequence your points so each one sets up the next.

MAKE IT EASY TO FOLLOW

# Design

### 10–20–30 Rule

10 slides, 20 minutes, 30-point font. Keep it tight.

### One Point per Slide

If a slide makes two points, it makes none.

### One Font, Maybe Two

Consistency reads as competence.

### Turn Words into Pictures or Diagrams

Show it visually before you explain it.

PROTECT THE STORY YOU'RE TELLING

# Compliance

## Enough and Concise, but not Too Much

Give what's needed to decide — nothing that buries it.

## Include Confidentiality, Trademark & Copyright Provisions

A short footer line protects your idea and your brand.

SECTION

# Content

The major parts of a pitch

03

THE FIRST 10 SECONDS

# Hook

**Open with a vision, video, statistic, or question — or set a clear expectation for your pitch.**

A clear, concise, engaging sentence of what you do.

*The only question in their head:* ***"Do I want to listen to this?"***

# Opportunity / Problem

**A strongly felt sentiment of the customer or the market.**

**ASK YOURSELF**

- *Is the problem true and validated?*
- *What evidence can you provide?*
- *Do I believe in it?*

EXAMPLE

# Airbnb

Lead with a unique market insight

① THE INSIGHT

**AirBed&Breakfast**

Book rooms with locals, rather than hotels.

② THE PROBLEM

- **Price** is a major concern when booking travel online.
- **Hotels** leave you disconnected from the city and its culture.
- **No easy way** exists to book a room with a local — or to become a host.

**The insight:** people will trust a stranger's home if the platform makes it safe, easy, and cheaper than a hotel.

# Product / Solution

**The developed solution and the main product of the company.**

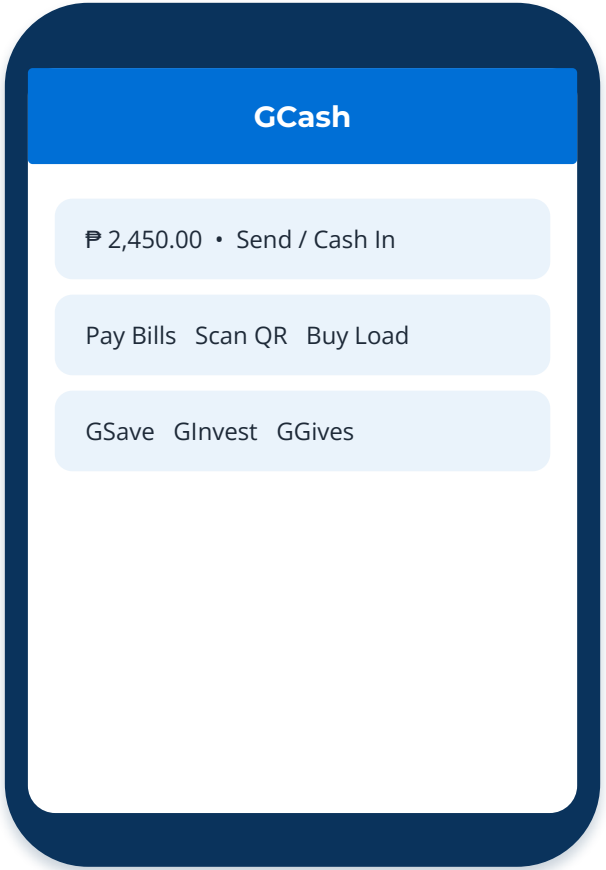
**ASK YOURSELF**

- *How does the product address the problem?*
- *What are the primary features?*
- *How is technology leveraged?*

EXAMPLE

# GCash

One line, then your top 3 features




**“Your money, on your phone.”** One app to send, pay, save, and borrow.

### Send & Receive
Transfer money instantly — even to other banks.

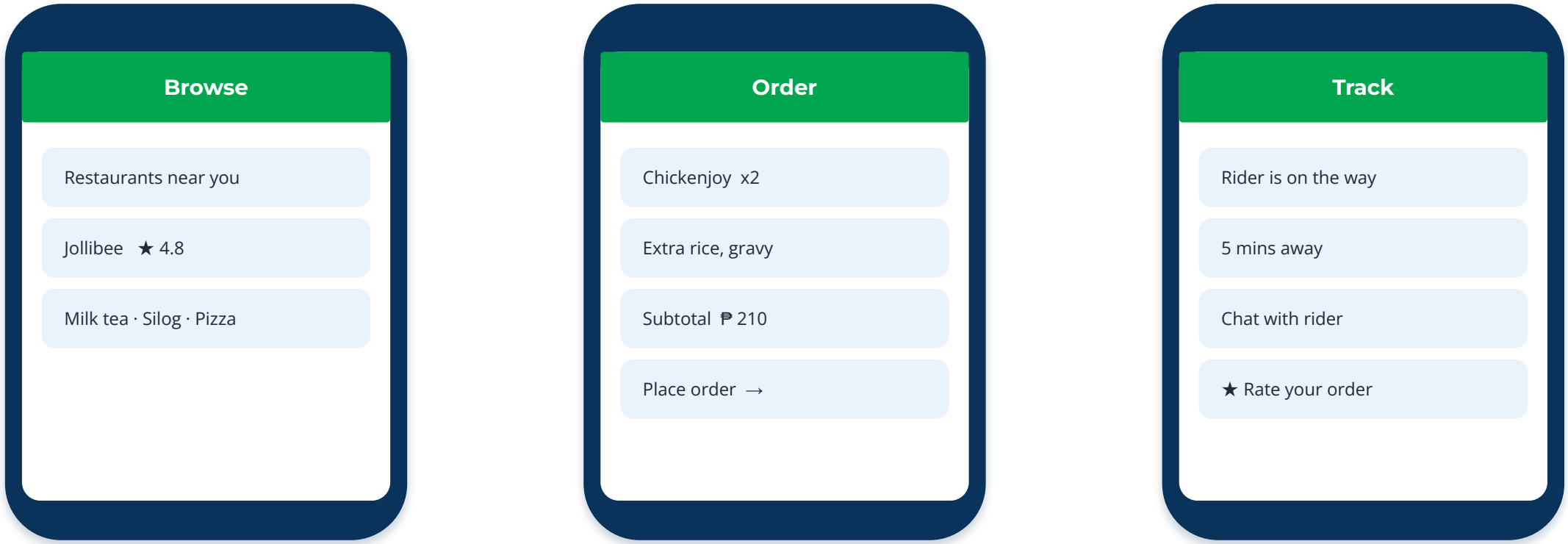
### Pay & Buy
Pay bills, scan QR at stores, and buy load in seconds.

### Grow & Borrow
Save, invest, and borrow via GSave, GInvest & GGives.

EXAMPLE

# GrabFood

Show the actual product, not a description




**Show, don't tell.** Three screens walk the judges through the whole experience: browse → order → track.

# Market

**Market size, market growth, and market segmentation.**

**ASK YOURSELF**

- *What is the TAM, SAM, and SOM?*
- *What are the trends in this market?*
- *What are the drivers in this market?*

MARKET SIZING, EXPLAINED

# TAM · SAM · SOM

**TAM — Total Addressable Market**

Everyone who could ever buy — the whole pie.

**SAM — Serviceable Addressable Market**

The share you can reach with your model and geography.

**SOM — Serviceable Obtainable Market**

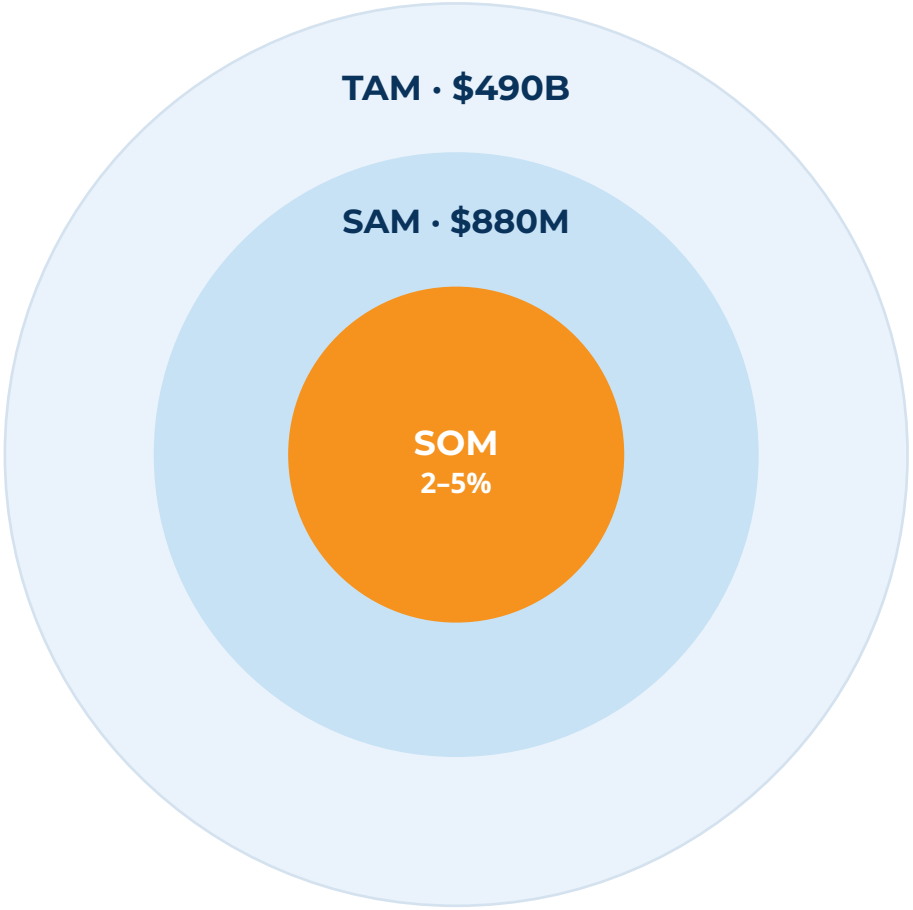
What you can realistically win first — your beachhead.

**Judges trust bottom-up logic:** *start from a defensible number, not a trillion-peso headline. Next up — how Predikta does it.*

EXAMPLE

# Market Sizing

TAM · SAM · SOM — Predikta (Netopia AI), a PH behavioral-AI startup




**TAM — $490B global**
Worldwide demand for behavioral, consumer, media & policy intelligence.

**SAM — $880M in the Philippines**
Predikta's PH slice across healthcare, e-commerce, media & marketing.

**SOM — 2–5% obtainable**
Won first through 3 pilot clients across brands, media & government.

*Adapted from Predikta's investor brief. Narrow from a global number down to what you can realistically win.*

EXAMPLE

# Market Trends & Gaps

Predikta (Netopia AI) — where the opportunity is heading

### THE TREND — WHERE IT'S HEADING

**The world wants the 'why'**
Data shows who, what, when, and where. The missing, most valuable piece is why people act.

**From hindsight to foresight**
Organizations want to predict reactions before launch, not analyze them after.

**GenAI × behavioral science**
New tech makes simulating human sentiment at national scale finally possible.

### THE GAP PREDIKTA OWNS

**No 'why' at scale**
Surveys and analytics can't explain motivation and intent.

**Slow & expensive**
Focus groups take weeks; a Predikta simulation takes minutes.

**Can't test the hypothetical**
You can't survey a campaign that hasn't launched — Predikta can.

**Growth areas:**
Consumer Brands · Gov't & Policy · Media & Content · Healthcare

**81–86%**
alignment with real sentiment (PH test)

# Business Model

**How the company makes money — revenues and costs.**

ASK YOURSELF

- *How are they making money?*
- *Is this model scalable?*

**Already covered in your Lean Canvas.** So we won't run a separate example here.
*Revisit the Revenue Streams and Cost Structure blocks of your canvas.*

# Traction

**The company's achievements to date.**

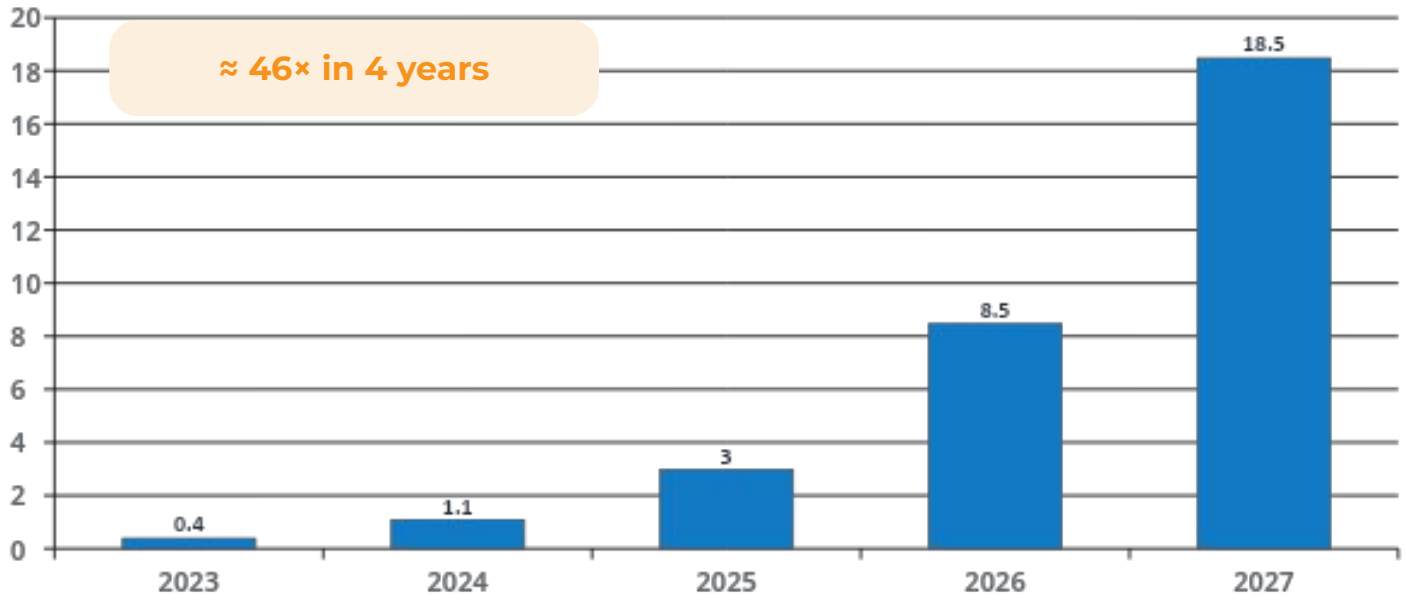
**ASK YOURSELF**

- *How much are they really making?*
- *How fast are they growing?*
- *Do the numbers match up?*

EXAMPLE

# Traction & Forecast

Illustrative example — momentum, metrics, and who's backing you




**MRR** Monthly Recurring Revenue
**₱32K → ₱1.5M**

**LTV** Lifetime Value
**₱20K → ₱24K**

**CAC** Customer Acquisition Cost
**₱665 → ₱401**

**Subscribers** Paying customers
**18 → 315**

PILOT CLIENTS · AFFILIATIONS · STRATEGIC PARTNERS (sample)

Corporate Pilot | Gov't Agency | SAP Partner | AWS Activate | University Lab | Accelerator

SPEAK THE INVESTOR'S LANGUAGE

# Metrics & Acronyms to Know

**ARR** Annual Recurring Revenue
MRR × 12 — your yearly run-rate.

**ARPU** Average Revenue Per User
Total revenue ÷ number of users.

**Burn** Burn Rate
How much cash you spend each month.

**Gross Margin** Gross Margin %
Revenue minus the cost to deliver it, as a %.

**GMV** Gross Merchandise Value
Total value of goods sold through your platform.

**Churn** Churn Rate
% of customers you lose each period.

**Runway** Months of Cash Left
How long your cash lasts before you run out.

**LTV:CAC** Value-to-Cost Ratio
Value of a customer vs. cost to win one — aim ≥ 3×.

# Team

**The experience and skills of the founding team.**

**ASK YOURSELF**

- *Can this team execute their plans?*
- *Do they have the right backgrounds and capabilities?*

EXAMPLE

# Team

Anatomy of a strong team slide

CC

**CEO / Co-Founder**
14 yrs in global investment & trading across multiple markets.

CC

**CSO / Co-Founder**
Renowned scientist, 50 yrs of deep-domain expertise; PhD.

TD

**Technical Director**
35 yrs of industry experience; ran a comparable company.

FP

**Finance & Projects**
20 yrs in the sector across 5 countries; MBA.

**What judges are really asking:** can THIS team actually build it?

EXAMPLE

# Team — Student Edition

No 20-year résumés? Show what you actually have.

CEO

**BS Management '26**

Ran the campus pop-up; led a 12-person org.

CTO

**BS Computer Science '26**

Built the working MVP; 2× hackathon finalist.

CMO

**BS Communication '27**

Grew a 25k-follower page; ran 3 campaigns.

## ALSO SHOW WHAT BACKS YOU

### Advisors & Mentors

A prof or industry mentor who vouches for you.

### Affiliations

Your school, org, or incubator — Startup QC, LaunchGarage.

### Partners

Anyone piloting your idea — an LGU, SME, or campus office.

### Investors / Grants

Any grant, prize, or pre-seed — even a small one.

# Competition

**A comparative analysis of the competitors.**

**ASK YOURSELF**

- *Do they understand their landscape?*
- *Do they have an established competitive advantage?*

EXAMPLE

# MindYou

List your competitors — then own the gap none of them fill

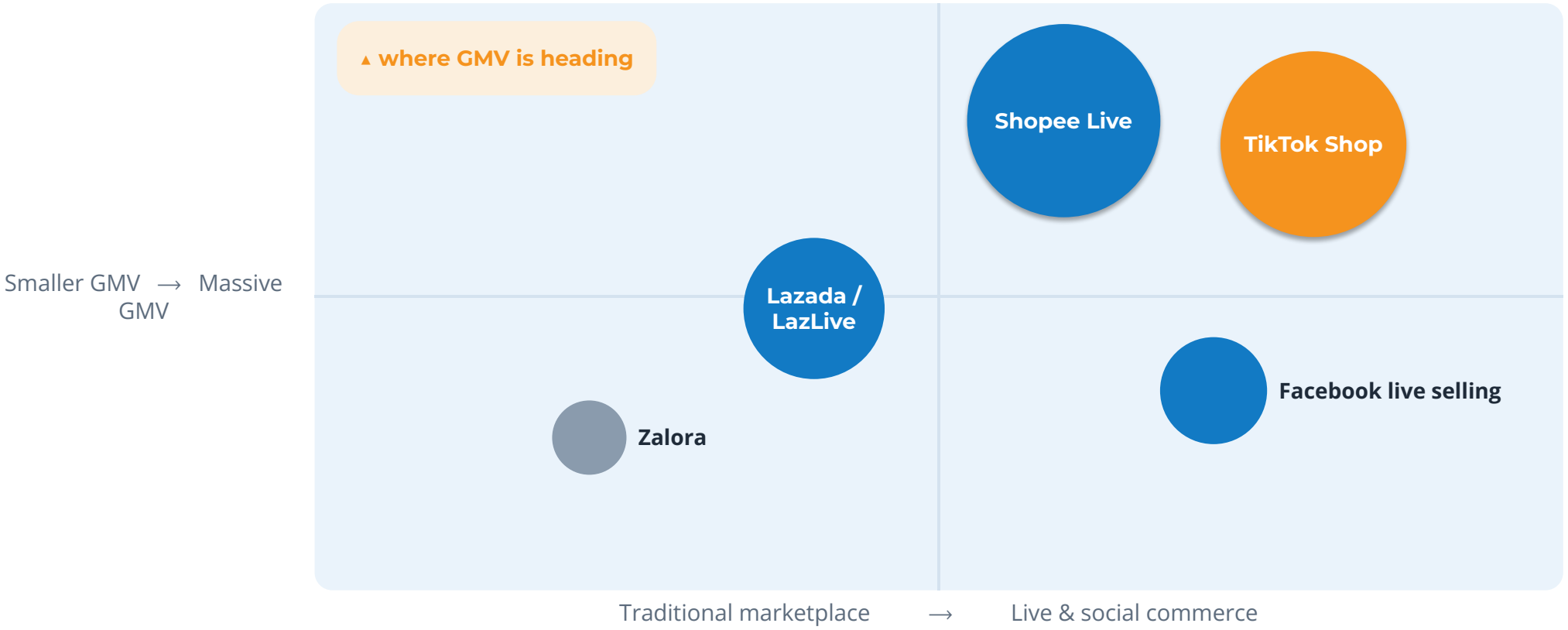
| Feature | MindNation | Infinit Care | Mindcare | MedGrocer | Intellect |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| HIPAA-Compliant Telehealth | ✗ | ✓ | ✓ | ✗ | ✓ |
| In-house Licensed Psychologists | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| **Evidence-based Psychometric Reporting** | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ |
| Leadership & Management Training | ✗ | ✓ | ✗ | ✗ | ✓ |
| Continuity of Care | ✗ | ✓ | ✗ | ✓ | ✗ |
| Insurance Integration | ✓ | ✗ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| HR Live Dashboard | ✓ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ |

**MindYou stays off the grid —** *it maps every rival, then owns the one row they all miss (highlighted).*

EXAMPLE

# Live Commerce

Competitive landscape by trend — the race for live-selling GMV




**The driver:** *selling is shifting to live streams. TikTok Shop is native to it; Shopee is countering hard with Shopee Live. Bubble size ≈ relative GMV (illustrative).*

THE CLOSE · MAKE THEM REMEMBER YOU

# End with impact, not information.

- Restate your vision in one clear line.
- Show the change you'll create — who's better off, and how.
- Tell the judges exactly what you want them to believe in.
- Leave them with one line they'll repeat.

*“We're not selling milk tea. We're funding a student's first business.”*

THE EIGHT BEATS OF A COMPLETE PITCH

# Summary

1. Opportunity
2. Product
3. Market
4. Business Model
5. Traction
6. Team
7. Competition
8. The Close

MY TAKE

# What Makes a Pitch Land

My personal take — three things that win

PRINCIPLE 1 · HIGH-IMPACT STATEMENTS, IN SUCCESSION

# Build Momentum

**Open each slide with one punchy, declarative line — then stack them so belief compounds.**

- One strong statement per slide, not a paragraph.
- Each line should earn the next.
- Short and confident beats long and hedged.

**Watch it build:** Problem is real → Market is massive → Product works → Numbers prove it → Back this team.

PRINCIPLE 2 · STORY OVER SPEC SHEET

# Tell a Narrative, Not a Report

**Take the judges on a journey from a real problem to a better future — don't read them a list of facts.**

- Give it an arc: problem → struggle → your solution → the win.
- Make the customer (or the country) the hero; you're the guide.
- Tie every slide back to the story, and cut what doesn't fit.

**Report → Narrative:** “5 features, big market” → “Here's who's hurting, why now, and how we fix it.”

PRINCIPLE 3 · PROOF OVER ADJECTIVES

# Specific Beats Hype

**Concrete numbers and real proof win over big adjectives.**

- Replace “huge market” with a sized, bottom-up number.
- Replace “lots of users” with the real figure and its growth.
- Show evidence: pilots, LOIs, screenshots, actual traction.

**Vague → Specific:** “Everyone will love this” → “18 paying users, +40% MoM, 3 signed pilots.”

LET'S TALK

# Q & A

Ask me anything.



SECTION

# Exercise

Let's put it into practice

05

YOUR TURN

# Elevator Pitch Run-Through

Peer Review

EXERCISE · HOW IT WORKS

# Pitch Parts Drill

**We'll rehearse the pitch one beat at a time — short, timed rounds — so each part lands before you string them together.**

1

## Watch

One group runs the full drill up front as a live demo.

2

## Debrief

As a class, we name what landed and what to sharpen.

3

## Do

Everyone splits into groups of 3–4 and runs the drill themselves.

**As we go:** we'll also be doing 1:1 consultations with each group along the way.

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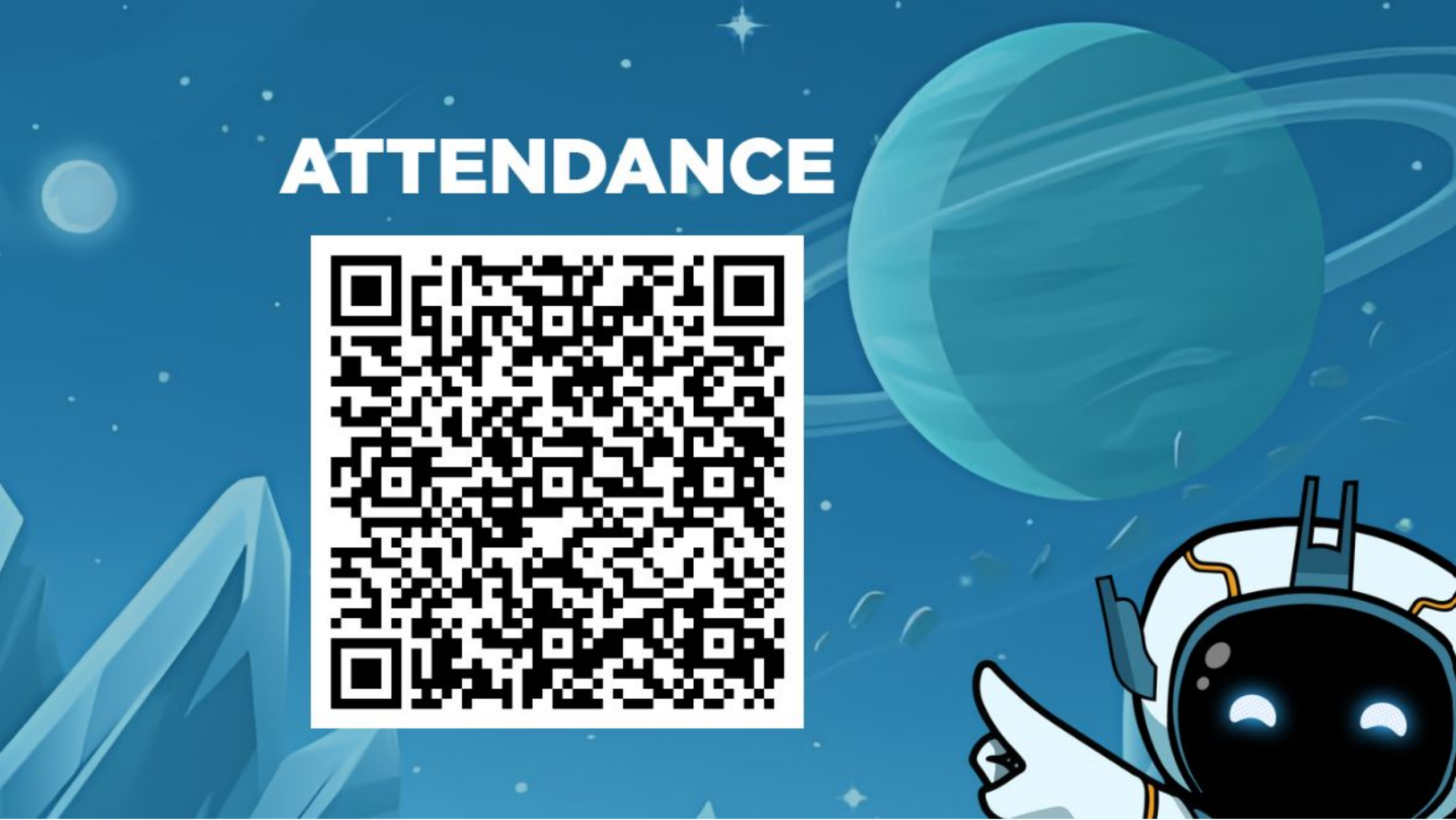
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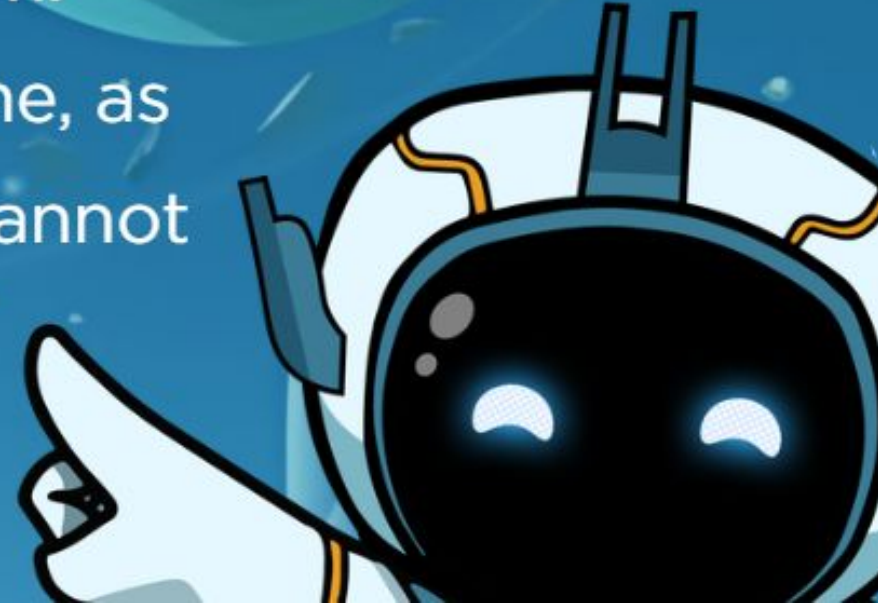
Abe Lozada · LaunchGarage × Startup QC

# ATTENDANCE



# ONE ON ONE MENTORSHIP

- Scan the QR code to schedule your appointment.
- Only one appointment is allowed per team.
- Kindly be on time, as one-on-one appointments cannot be rescheduled.



# PITCH PRACTICE

- Each team will have a maximum of 5 minutes for pitching and 10 minutes for mentor feedback.
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**JULY 23 & 24, 2026**



# REMINDER

submission of
improved business plan and
video pitch

**JUL 28**



# CONTENT GUIDELINES

## COMPANY NAME
*What's the name of your startup?*

## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY
*An overview of your business plan*

## WHY JOIN STARTUP QC

## PROBLEM
*What issue does your business tackle, and what gap does it fill?*

## GOALS & OBJECTIVES
*What outcomes do you aim for, and what metrics will measure success over time?*

## SOLUTION
*What key approach will your business concept take to solve the problem and add value for your target market?*

## PROOF OF CONCEPT
*Technical feasibility of the product & business plan*

## MARKET ANALYSIS
*Present an analysis of market trends, target demographics, and competitive landscape.*

## BUSINESS MODEL
*How a company creates value and generates revenue*

## TEAM PROFILE
*Brief introduction and achievements about the team*

## ***REMINDERS:***

### *Business Plan Format*

- The business plan must not exceed ten (10) pages.
  ***excluding title slide and references (if any)*
- The business plan must be in PDF format
- Font: Arial
- Font Size: 12
- Margin: 1 on all sides
- Line Spacing: 1.15
- Body text: justified
- With page numbers.

### *Video Pitch*

- Present your business plan clearly in under five (5) minutes, showcasing the proof of concept.
- Ensure the content is suitable for viewers of all ages.

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STUDENT CATEGORY · SQUAD 3

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The Anatomy of a Winning Pitch

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